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Student medical care just routine

By Jeff Barton
Third in a series

"Persons who are in bad shape are encouraged to go to a hospital instead of the Health Service," a University Health Service physician said.

Dr. Curtis Lyman, who sees student patients during the morning office hours, also said he agreed with the administration's policy of offering limited services.

"From a practical standpoint I feel we should operate as a general practitioner's office does," he explained. Lyman said he feels current facilities are adequate to permit such a practice. He has been with the Health Service for 11 years and was formerly a physician at the Texas Tech University Health Service.

"When I was there (Texas Tech) we were doing no more in the way of full-time testing than we do here," he said. He added that Tech's facility was oriented to a primarily noncommuter student body. "One basic difference was that it was not uncommon to see a student wait hours to see a doctor," he said.

Both Lyman and Jane Peck, Health Service supervisor, agree that the University's service should be geared to routine diagnostic practice. Each admits the service's emergency facilities are limited.

Mrs. Peck said in an earlier interview, "We have the patients to justify a full-time physician, but not the facilities." She indicated the present arrangement of consulting part-time

physicians and minimal lab work at the center is "adequate" for the needs of students.

Lyman said, "we operate much like a family physician's office. We don't claim to be an emergency room."

So what happens if a student has a serious accident? Lyman said the Health Service is not equipped to handle "serious emergency care." He indicated the service was not set up to provide such treatment because of its proximity to local hospitals.

"Since we're so close to a first-rate emergency room (Providence Memorial Hospital), we refer serious emergency cases to them," he said.

But what happens if, say, a student athlete has a coronary at the baseball field across the street from the Health Service?

"We don't have a defibrillator, but we can do simple resuscitation. We have more emergency equipment than the average physician's office. But we're lucky—we've never had such an emergency," Lyman said.

The physician said students needing emergency treatment are encouraged to go directly to the Providence emergency room.

"We would just delay the process and they are so close. Emergency care is really getting to be a complicated thing these days. About all we can do is use the nearest facilities. Sometimes we use the campus police to transport cases to the hospital. It's really only a minute or so away," he said.

Both Lyman and Peck said they preferred the service to remain the way it is now, and for the same reason—money.

"It isn't just a question of adding one full-time physician," Lyman said. "I think you'd have to go to two full-time doctors as a minimum. Salaries would have to be between \$35,000 and \$40,000. Plus you'd have to have the University pay fringe benefits like malpractice insurance," he added. The physicians currently pay their own, he explained.

So the question seems to be whether updating the facilities is worth the cost. Students are using the current facilities for routine ailments, service officials say, which is its aim. But a 1973 study indicated students wanted more emergency treatment facilities and a pharmacy.

Why, then, has nothing been done?

"What we have to decide is whether we want a hospital or a first-aid station," Wynn Anderson, assistant to the president, said recently.

"Things have changed since the study simply because costs have gone up so much," Lyman said.

Plans to increase the services would "be a big investment," Mrs. Peck said, because, "We haven't got a big enough facility for a full-time physician here—He'd be bored." It would, she emphasized, "be a big investment."

The question, then, seems to be, "How much is too much for good health care?"

Cohen says sports teach many facts of life

By Johnny Hawkins

Society often labels athletes "jocks," men playing boyish games with their lives instead of facing the hard facts of life.

UT El Paso baseball coach Andy Cohen says, however, that athletics can be a way of life, learning and wisdom.

"I've been into baseball on the professional level now for 45 years, and I've learned many of the basic necessities of life," Cohen said.

What makes the thud of a stick of wood against a speeding sphere, the clasp of the ball in a glove and the race for that diamond-shaped pot of gold enchant a man for his entire life?

"When I first played professional baseball in the late 1920s and 1930s (Great Depression times), a player didn't have a managing agent, many benefits or much pay. It was a rough way to make a living and you had to love the game to stay," Cohen said.

Cohen said.

Cohen, a native El Pasoan, was graduated from El Paso High in 1921 where he started as a basketball, baseball and football player. He went to the University of Alabama on a scholarship and again was a three-letter man. But baseball was his first love, and second base his first calling.

In 1925 Cohen finished college and went to play minor league baseball in Waco. That next year the legendary John McGraw of the New York Giants signed him for a one-year stretch.

"McGraw was a strict disciplinarian," Cohen recalls. "I remember once there was a guy at bat with his brother on first base and two outs against their team. The ball was hit to me, and I forfeited the easy out for an attempted double play, with a bad throw."

"After the game, which we lost, McGraw told me, 'Son you are in the major leagues now, and we don't try double plays with two outs'."

Cohen's major league career briefly switched to minor league status when he spent three years at Newark, N.J., then about one year at Buffalo N.Y., followed by one more year with the Giants. Later Cohen was traded to a Minneapolis team for \$25,000 and one man for his longest stint with a single team, nine and a half years.

"I was always traveling during my career, which teaches me so many lessons about people and how to survive in the world today," Cohen said. "I remember watching my brother Syd of the Washington Senators strike out 'Babe' Ruth of the Yankees in Ruth's last American League game."

"Ruth also hit a homer on Syd that day," Cohen added.

One more year of ball playing with the New Orleans Pelicans after the war boosted Cohen's career as a player to 21 years. "My most enterprising lesson in all those years was to learn from sports to never give up at anything," Cohen said.

Being appointed as last minute stand-in for the assistant manager of the Philadelphia Phillies in a 1960 game against the Milwaukee Braves was one of Cohen's most exciting baseball moments. They won 5-4 in ten innings.

He has worked as a trainer, manager and scout for such major league clubs as the Pittsburgh Pirates, Boston Braves, Brooklyn Dodgers and Chicago White Sox.

Cohen has coached the UT El Paso team since 1962. As a basis for his team's education he uses the "fundamentals" and inside baseball tips taught to him by McGraw and the philosophy of sports taught him by Luther Coblenz, his high school coach.

Syd Cohen, the brother who fanned the Sultan of Swat, and who also serves as an assistant to his brother, remembers when



"blacks couldn't participate in baseball with whites so they had their own leagues. Later they changed the rule with the introduction of Jackie Robinson, who stood a lot of stuff just to be able to play."

"In my time the fellows used to be guys who drank beer together after the games, not caring about the little pay. Now baseball is big business," he explained.

Jim Bowden, athletic director, who remembers watching Syd play and had heard of Andy's talent, said, "They are both knowledgeable baseball authorities. Andy is a super guy. He can coach the team for as long as state rules permit."

The aging coach, who declined to give his age for publication, still makes it to practice almost daily to work out with the players.

"He stresses education first then sports interest," Mike Rima, pitcher, said.

"This year's team finds it easier than ever before to take our ideas for improvement to Cohen and have something done about them," Dave Jannusch, co captain said. "Everybody on the team likes and respects Andy and Syd as people and coaches."

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